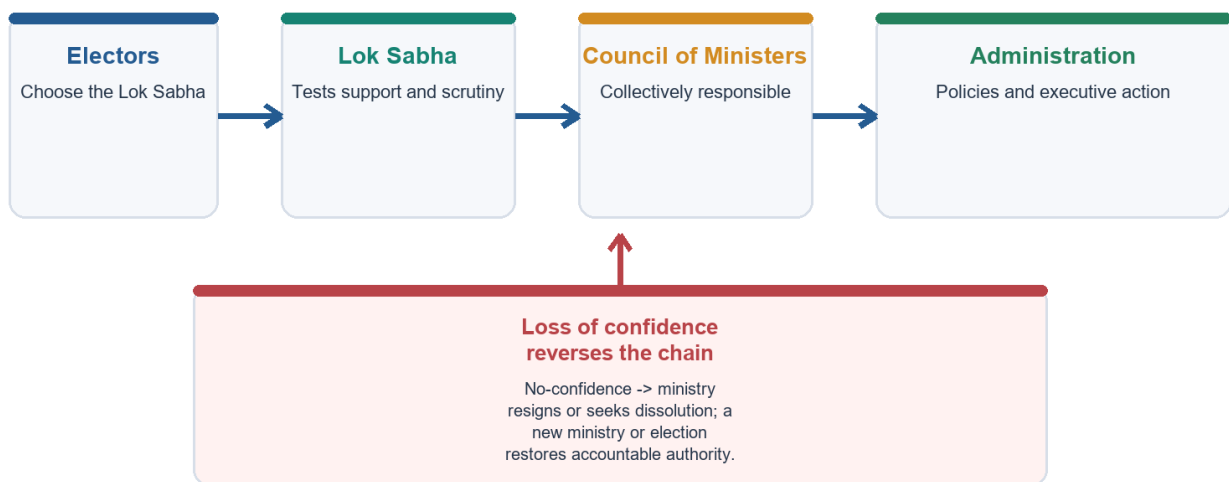


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Responsible government: the confidence chain

Political authority is renewed through representation, scrutiny and confidence.



Polity 11 | Original deterministic study visual

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Mains answer spine: parliamentary-system questions

Build a directive-sensitive answer from definition to qualified verdict.



Polity 11 | Original deterministic study visual

A high-scoring answer defines the relationship, anchors it in law, explains mechanism, adds evidence, qualifies and gives a graded verdict.

Workbook boundary: Everything from this heading through the original Mains practice is reproduced in the separate solved-practice workbook. Final register notes are intentionally excluded from that workbook.

Verified routed PYQ laboratory

PYQ 1 - UPSC Prelims 2020, GS-I, Q11

Question: A Parliamentary System of Government is one in which:

A. all political parties in the Parliament are represented in the Government B. the Government is responsible to the Parliament and can be removed by it C. the Government is elected by the people and can be removed by them D. the Government is chosen by the Parliament but cannot be removed by it before completion of a fixed term

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B.

- A is wrong: an opposition remains outside government; an all-party ministry is not a defining requirement.
- B is correct: political responsibility and removability through the lower House are the controlling features.
- C is wrong: electors choose legislators; the ministry ordinarily emerges through the House majority and is removed by confidence procedure.
- D is wrong: fixed, confidence-independent tenure is presidential, not parliamentary.
- **Confidence:** Very high. The local official question is verified; the historical official key is not held locally.

PYQ 2 - UPSC Prelims 2021, GS-I, Q77

Question: We adopted parliamentary democracy based on the British model, but how does our model differ from that model?

1. As regards legislation, the British Parliament is supreme or sovereign, but in India, the power of Parliament to legislate is limited.
2. In India, matters related to the constitutionality of the amendment of an Act of Parliament are referred to the Constitution Bench by the Supreme Court.

Select the correct answer:

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: C.

- Statement 1 is correct: Indian legislation is limited by legislative competence, Fundamental Rights, other constitutional provisions and judicial review; orthodox British doctrine treats Parliament as sovereign.
- Statement 2 is accepted as correct in the PYQ's intended frame: Article 145(3) requires at least five judges where a case involves a substantial question of law as to constitutional interpretation.
- [LIMIT] Not every routine statutory challenge becomes a Constitution Bench matter; the constitutional threshold is a **substantial question of interpretation**.
- **Confidence:** High. The local official question is verified; the historical official key is not held locally.

PYQ 3 - UPSC GS-II 2024, Q3 - direct owner

Question: "The growth of cabinet system has practically resulted in the marginalisation of the parliamentary supremacy." Elucidate. **10 marks | 150 words**

Demand decoding

- "Elucidate" requires mechanism and evidence, not a generic merits/demerits list.
- "Parliamentary supremacy" must be clarified as effective control and deliberation, not UK-style legal sovereignty.
- A high-scoring answer should accept the tendency, identify correctives and give a qualified verdict.

Model solution

India's cabinet is drawn from Parliament and remains responsible to Lok Sabha under Article 75(3). Yet this fusion can allow the executive to dominate the institution meant to scrutinise it.

First, a disciplined majority and the whip, reinforced by the Tenth Schedule, usually make government defeat unlikely and reduce independent legislative voting. Second, the cabinet controls most House business and time; guillotining of demands for grants, compressed debate and limited committee referral weaken financial and legislative examination. Third, delegated legislation, ordinances under Article 123 and an overbroad Money Bill route can reduce prior bicameral scrutiny. PMO-centred coordination may further convert cabinet government into prime-ministerial government.

However, Parliament retains no-confidence power, Question Hour, motions, DRSCs and PAC-CAG scrutiny. Courts enforce constitutional limits, and elections renew accountability.

Thus, cabinet growth has marginalised Parliament's **deliberative and control functions**, not created British-style cabinet sovereignty. The remedy is more sittings, routine committee scrutiny and narrower whip use.

Why this earns marks

- Opens with Article 75(3) and directly resolves the sovereignty/supremacy ambiguity.
- Uses a mechanism chain: majority -> whip -> agenda/time -> executive law tools -> PM concentration.
- Adds named correctives and a reform-oriented, qualified conclusion within 10-mark scope.

PYQ 4 - UPSC GS-II 2018, Q13 - supporting/cross-owned

Question: India and USA are two large democracies. Examine the basic tenets on which the two political systems are based. **15 marks | 250 words**

Ownership label: Cross-owned by comparative constitutional design; included here because parliamentary-presidential structure is central to the demand.

Demand decoding

- "Examine" requires both common constitutional commitments and structural differences.
- Avoid reducing the answer to a table of President versus PM.
- Use evidence from constitutional form, federalism, rights, review and accountability.

Model solution

India and the United States are constitutional, federal, republican democracies committed to representative government, rights and judicial review. Their basic tenets overlap, but the institutional routes differ.

Common foundations: Both derive authority from a written Constitution, divide power federally, protect enforceable rights and entrust courts with constitutional review. Bicameral national legislatures represent population and constituent units, while periodic elections provide democratic legitimacy.

Different executive principles: India adopts responsible parliamentary government. Articles 74-75 create a dual executive: the President is the formal head, while the PM-Council governs subject to Lok Sabha confidence. The United States has a single elected President with fixed tenure; cabinet secretaries cannot sit in Congress and are not collectively responsible to it.

Different separation logic: India uses functional fusion and coordination, qualified by judicial review and federal distribution. The US uses a stricter separation with presidential veto, Senate confirmation and congressional oversight, creating checks but also deadlock risk.

Federal and political variation: India has a stronger Union, single citizenship and an integrated judiciary; the US combines constitutionally stronger States, dual political citizenship and dual court structures. Indian party discipline and anti-defection rules strengthen executive control over the legislature; US divided government may intensify bargaining.

Therefore, both systems seek limited democratic government, but India prioritises daily legislative responsibility, whereas the US prioritises fixed tenure and institutional separation. Neither model ensures accountability or stability automatically; outcomes depend on parties, federal practice and constitutional restraint.

Why this earns marks

- Answers “basic tenets” through shared foundations plus institutional differences.
- Uses named Articles and exact comparison axes rather than slogans.
- Includes effects and qualifications: responsibility versus stability, fusion versus deadlock, strong Union versus State autonomy.

PYQ 5 - UPSC GS-II 2023, Q4 - supporting/cross-owned

Question: Compare and contrast the British and Indian approaches to Parliamentary sovereignty. **10 marks | 150 words**

Ownership label: Cross-owned by comparative constitutional design; included here to prevent confusion between parliamentary government and parliamentary sovereignty.

Model solution

Britain and India both practise responsible cabinet government, but their approaches to legislative authority differ fundamentally.

Under orthodox British doctrine, Parliament may enact or repeal any law; courts interpret Acts but cannot invalidate them merely for inconsistency with a superior codified Constitution. The constitutional order is largely uncoded and conventions regulate much executive practice.

India instead adopts **constitutional supremacy**. Parliament's ordinary law-making is limited by the Seventh Schedule, Fundamental Rights and other constitutional provisions, and is subject to judicial review. Even the Article 368 amending power is limited by the basic-structure doctrine. Federalism and bicameral representation further distribute authority.

Similarity remains in political responsibility: in both systems the cabinet survives through lower-House confidence and normally controls the legislative agenda.

Thus, India borrowed Westminster responsible government but constitutionalised and limited it. British parliamentary sovereignty concerns legal competence; Indian “parliamentary supremacy” is better understood as Parliament's political control over the executive within a supreme Constitution.

Why this earns marks

- Defines the precise legal contrast before listing institutional evidence.
- Uses Seventh Schedule, Fundamental Rights, judicial review, Article 368 and basic structure.
- Ends by separating sovereignty from responsible government, the core trap in the question.

Original hard MCQ set - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Article 74 control

Consider the following statements:

1. The President may require ministerial advice to be reconsidered once.
2. After reconsideration, the President may permanently reject the advice.
3. Article 74(2) bars inquiry into the advice but does not necessarily bar review of the resulting action.

Which is correct?

A. 1 and 3 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 only D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A.

The 44th Amendment permits one reconsideration, after which the advice binds. Article 74(2) protects advice from inquiry; constitutional review of the action may still proceed on available material and legal grounds.

OM2. Union-State architecture

Which pairing is correct?

A. Article 77 - collective responsibility to Lok Sabha B. Article 167 - Chief Minister's communication duties to the Governor C. Article 88 - State Council's responsibility to Assembly D. Article 166 - President's rules for Union business

Answer: B.

Article 167 is the State parallel to Article 78. Article 77 concerns Union executive business, Article 88 parliamentary participation, and Article 166 State executive business.

OM3. Ministry-size controls

Consider the following:

1. Union ministry: maximum 15% of Lok Sabha strength.
2. State ministry: maximum 15% of Legislative Assembly strength.
3. State ministry: constitutional minimum of 12.
4. These caps were introduced by the 91st Amendment.

Which is correct?

A. 1 and 4 only B. 1, 2 and 4 only C. 1, 2, 3 and 4 D. 2 and 3 only

Answer: C.

Articles 75(1A) and 164(1A), inserted by the 91st Amendment, establish the two 15% caps; the State Council also has a minimum of 12.

OM4. Minister in the other House

A Union minister who belongs to Rajya Sabha attends Lok Sabha. Which statement is most accurate?

A. The minister cannot speak because the minister is not a Lok Sabha member. B. The minister may speak and vote because executive office overrides membership. C. The minister may vote only on government bills. D. The minister may speak and participate but cannot vote in Lok Sabha.

Answer: D.

Article 88 enables participation in either House, joint sittings and named committees, but gives no vote by virtue of office. Voting follows House membership.

OM5. Nominal and real executive

Which proposition best reflects *Shamsher Singh*?

A. President and Governor are formal heads ordinarily acting on responsible advice, subject to constitutionally recognised Governor discretion. B. The President has a personal popular mandate equal to Lok Sabha. C. All gubernatorial discretion is unconstitutional. D. Article 53 allows the President to govern without a Council.

Answer: A.

The case constitutionalises the formal-head position and ministerial responsibility. It does not erase specific gubernatorial discretion or create personal presidential government.

OM6. Dissolution and continuity

What was the central implication of *U.N.R. Rao v. Indira Gandhi*?

A. Lok Sabha dissolution automatically dismisses the Council. B. The Council continues because Article 74 remains mandatory even while confidence cannot be tested in a dissolved House. C. The President governs alone until elections. D. Article 75(3) is permanently suspended after dissolution.

Answer: B.

The Court harmonised continuity under Article 74 with confidence under Article 75(3). Dissolution prevents an immediate floor test; it does not terminate responsible government.

OM7. Non-member Prime Minister

Which is correct after *S.P. Anand*?

A. Only an existing Lok Sabha member can become PM. B. A Rajya Sabha member cannot become PM. C. A non-member may become PM but must enter either House within six months. D. A non-member PM may continue until the next general election.

Answer: C.

Article 75(5) permits a six-month window. The Indian Constitution does not import the British convention that the PM must sit in the Commons.

OM8. Floor-test doctrine

Which statement is the most precise use of *S.R. Bommai* in this topic?

A. It makes every Union bill a confidence vote. B. It gives Governors unrestricted discretion to assess support privately. C. It abolishes Article 356. D. It supports floor determination of disputed Assembly majority and judicial review of Article 356 material.

Answer: D.

Bommai's main operational field is State government and President's Rule. It supports the wider responsible-government principle that legislative support is tested in the House.

OM9. Collective responsibility

Which statement best captures collective responsibility?

A. The ministry must retain Lok Sabha confidence and publicly stand by settled cabinet policy as a team. B. Every minister is individually elected by Lok Sabha. C. Rajya Sabha may dismiss the Council through no-confidence. D. Cabinet disagreement is legally prohibited even inside meetings.

Answer: A.

Collective responsibility combines confidence and solidarity. Internal debate is possible; public opposition while remaining in office conflicts with cabinet solidarity.

OM10. Financial defeat

Which is the safest constitutional formulation?

A. Defeat of any government amendment automatically removes the ministry. B. Express confidence defeat or denial of essential supply is decisive/grave; ordinary legislative defeat requires contextual assessment. C. Rajya Sabha rejection of a Money Bill dismisses the Council. D. The Budget has no relationship with confidence.

Answer: B.

Parliamentary convention treats supply as essential to governing, but not every adverse division is automatically a confidence loss. Lok Sabha is the confidence chamber.

OM11. Political homogeneity

In a coalition ministry, political homogeneity is best understood as:

A. a constitutional requirement that every minister belong to one party. B. a prohibition on regional parties entering government. C. negotiated consensus around a common programme rather than identical ideology. D. automatic loss of office whenever partners disagree.

Answer: C.

Homogeneity is a classic political tendency. Coalition government adapts it through agreed programmes and cabinet solidarity.

OM12. Secrecy

Which statement is correct?

A. The oath of secrecy eliminates Parliament's right to seek information. B. Cabinet secrecy prevails over every court order. C. Secrecy is merely a political convention with no constitutional oath. D. Secrecy protects candid deliberation but coexists with legislative, judicial, audit and statutory accountability.

Answer: D.

Ministers take the Third Schedule oath. Its purpose is not absolute executive opacity.

OM13. System comparison

Which combination correctly distinguishes parliamentary from presidential government?

A. Confidence-dependent ministry, legislative membership and possible lower-House dissolution. B. Fixed executive tenure, collective responsibility and fusion. C. Separate executive selection with ministerial membership of Congress. D. Lower-House confidence with President unable to dissolve it in any circumstance.

Answer: A.

The parliamentary cluster is responsibility, double membership and dissolution. Presidential government features separate selection, fixed tenure and separation.

OM14. US executive terminology

Which is correct?

A. "Kitchen Cabinet" is the constitutional collective name for US departmental secretaries. B. US cabinet secretaries are formal executive officers; "kitchen cabinet" refers to informal advisers. C. US secretaries remain members of Congress while serving. D. The House of Representatives can dismiss the US cabinet by no-confidence.

Answer: B.

The informal label must not be confused with the formal cabinet. The presidential executive is not collectively responsible to Congress.

OM15. India-Britain difference

Consider the following:

1. India is a republic; Britain a constitutional monarchy.
2. India has a written supreme Constitution; Britain follows parliamentary sovereignty.
3. India's PM may be from either House; Britain's PM is by convention from the Commons.

Which is correct?

A. 1 only B. 1 and 2 only C. 1, 2 and 3 D. 2 and 3 only

Answer: C.

All three distinctions are central. India constitutionalised Westminster responsibility without importing Crown heredity or parliamentary legal omnipotence.

OM16. Adoption rationale

Which was **not** a defensible reason for India's adoption of parliamentary government?

A. Familiarity with responsible institutions B. Preference for daily responsibility C. Accommodation of plural representation D. Desire to make Parliament legally sovereign over the Constitution

Answer: D.

India chose responsible government under constitutional supremacy. The design rejected British-style unlimited parliamentary sovereignty.

OM17. Coalition evidence

Which conclusion is best supported by Indian experience?

A. Coalitions can be unstable, but full-term coalitions show instability is conditional rather than inherent. B. Every coalition necessarily collapses before five years. C. Anti-defection guarantees perfect cabinet stability. D. Single-party governments cannot produce cabinet dominance.

Answer: A.

Short-lived governments demonstrate risk; full-term NDA and UPA coalitions demonstrate negotiated stability. Institutional incentives and political conditions matter.

OM18. Cabinet-dominance chain

Which sequence is most accurate?

A. Judicial review -> cabinet secrecy -> parliamentary sovereignty B. Majority + whip -> agenda/time control -> reduced scrutiny, qualified by committees and confidence power C. Federalism -> fixed tenure -> no dissolution D. Rajya Sabha no-confidence -> PM dismissal

Answer: B.

The majority-whip-agenda mechanism explains practical dominance. It is checked, not erased, by scrutiny institutions.

OM19. PRS evidence

Which statement reflects the verified PRS anchor used in this package?

A. The 17th Lok Sabha sat more than every earlier full-term House. B. All Bills in the 17th Lok Sabha were referred to committees. C. It sat 274 days, while committee referral was lower than in the 16th and 15th Lok Sabhas. D. PRS found that parliamentary committees had been abolished.

Answer: C.

PRS reported 274 sitting days and a 16% referral rate, down from 28% in the 16th and 71% in the 15th Lok Sabha.

OM20. Simultaneous-elections control

As of 16 August 2026, which is correct?

A. Article 82A is operative constitutional law. B. Parliament has enacted a mandatory implementation year. C. The Joint Committee has conclusively upheld every provision. D. The 129th Amendment Bill remains a proposal under Joint Committee consideration.

Answer: D.

The Bill was introduced on 17 December 2024 and remains under committee review. No enacted Article 82A or implementation year may be asserted.

OM21. Articles 77 and 78

Which pairing is correct?

A. Article 77 - form/authentication/allocation of Union business; Article 78 - PM's information duties to President. B. Article 77 - no-confidence; Article 78 - ministerial oath. C. Article 77 - parliamentary privilege; Article 78 - dissolution. D. Article 77 - State business; Article 78 - Governor discretion.

Answer: A.

Article 77 structures executive business in the President's name; Article 78 sustains the constitutional communication channel.

OM22. State Council

Which statement is correct?

A. State Council is collectively responsible to Legislative Council wherever one exists. B. It is collectively responsible to the Legislative Assembly, and the 15% cap is subject to a minimum of 12 ministers. C. Governor may permanently reject reconsidered advice in all matters. D. A non-legislator State minister has a twelve-month window.

Answer: B.

Article 164 mirrors the lower-House confidence rule, applies a six-month membership window and imposes the cap/minimum.

OM23. Three responsibility concepts

Which classification is correct?

A. Collective responsibility means each minister must countersign every presidential act. B. Individual responsibility means Rajya Sabha can dismiss one minister. C. Collective responsibility concerns the team before Lok Sabha; individual tenure operates through pleasure/PM advice; India lacks the British universal countersignature model. D. Legal responsibility and collective responsibility are identical.

Answer: C.

The three concepts answer different questions: survival of ministry, tenure of individual minister, and formal legal authentication/countersignature.

OM24. Advanced labels

Which is correct?

A. "Prime-ministerial government" is text in Article 78. B. "Cabinet dictatorship" is a binding Supreme Court doctrine. C. "Elective dictatorship" abolishes the need for elections. D. These are analytical labels for power distribution and must not be treated as constitutional rules.

Answer: D.

Bagehot, Jennings, Laski/Muir, Crossman/Mackintosh and core-executive analysis help interpret practice; the Constitution remains the legal framework.

Remedial MCQ loop - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

RM1. Advice after reconsideration

The President returns advice once. The Council reaffirms it. What follows?

A. The President must act according to the reconsidered advice. B. The President may call a referendum. C. The President may refer it to Rajya Sabha. D. The advice automatically lapses.

Answer: A.

The 44th Amendment created a single reconsideration opportunity, not a permanent veto.

RM2. Confidence chamber

Which body can remove the Union Council through a no-confidence motion?

A. Rajya Sabha alone B. Lok Sabha C. Joint sitting D. Supreme Court

Answer: B.

Article 75(3) fixes collective responsibility to Lok Sabha. Courts enforce law; they do not hold confidence votes.

RM3. Six-month rule

A person appointed minister while not a member of Parliament:

A. can never vote but may remain for five years. B. must enter Lok Sabha only. C. must become a member of either House within six consecutive months or cease to be minister. D. receives automatic Rajya Sabha membership.

Answer: C.

The temporary exception preserves appointment flexibility while requiring legislative connection.

RM4. Government versus sovereignty

Which statement is correct?

A. Parliamentary government always makes Parliament legally unlimited. B. India follows British parliamentary sovereignty. C. Judicial review is incompatible with responsible government. D. India has parliamentary government within a supreme, judicially enforceable Constitution.

Answer: D.

The confidence relationship and the location of final legal authority are separate constitutional questions.

RM5. US “Kitchen Cabinet”

The safest statement is:

A. A kitchen cabinet is an informal adviser circle, not the constitutional machinery of US departmental secretaries. B. It is the US lower House. C. It is collectively responsible to Congress. D. Its members must be senators.

Answer: A.

This correction prevents a common textbook-label overreach.

RM6. Government defeat

Which formulation is most accurate?

A. Every lost division automatically dissolves Lok Sabha. B. No-confidence or denial of essential supply is decisive/grave; other defeats require context. C. Rajya Sabha alone determines Union confidence. D. Financial business never affects confidence.

Answer: B.

Confidence doctrine is serious but should not be converted into an automatic rule for every bill or amendment.

RM7. Floor test

The floor-test doctrine is most directly associated in this package with:

A. appointment of Supreme Court judges. B. authentication under Article 77. C. disputed State-government majority and Article 356 review. D. election of the President.

Answer: C.

Use Bommai to show that majority is proved in the representative chamber; take procedural Governor detail to Polity 19.

RM8. Article 82A status

As of the package control date:

A. Article 82A has already shortened every Assembly term. B. The President has notified the first simultaneous cycle. C. The Supreme Court has approved a final implementation year. D. Article 82A remains proposed text in a pending constitutional-amendment Bill.

Answer: D.

The proposal is relevant to the stability-accountability debate only; it is not current law.

Original Mains practice with examiner-grade models

M1. 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Explain how Articles 74, 75, 77, 78 and 88 together convert formal executive power into responsible government.

Demand decoding

- “Explain how” requires an integrated mechanism, not five isolated Article definitions.

- Connect advice, appointment, business form, information and parliamentary participation.

Model solution

The Constitution formally vests Union executive power in the President, but Articles 74, 75, 77, 78 and 88 make its exercise politically responsible.

Article 74 places a PM-headed Council to aid and advise the President; after one reconsideration, the advice binds, while Article 74(2) protects the advice from judicial inquiry. Article 75 then gives the arrangement democratic content: ministers are appointed within a PM-led structure, hold office during pleasure, take constitutional oaths and are collectively responsible to Lok Sabha. The six-month rule ensures that even an initially non-member minister acquires legislative membership.

Article 77 converts decisions into valid executive form through action in the President's name and business-allocation rules. Article 78 requires the PM to communicate decisions and information to the President, preserving consultation without personal presidential government. Article 88 allows ministers to participate in either House, though voting remains tied to membership.

Together, these provisions join constitutional form, cabinet decision and legislative accountability: the President acts formally, the Council decides politically, and Lok Sabha controls survival.

Why this earns marks

- Integrates all five Articles through one causal chain.
- Uses the reconsideration, six-month and voting caveats.
- Ends with a crisp nominal-head/real-executive/confidence synthesis.

M2. 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Collective responsibility is both a rule of government survival and a rule of cabinet solidarity. Analyse with judicial support.

Demand decoding

- Address both confidence and solidarity.
- Use at least two cases and qualify dissolution/floor-test context.

Model solution

Article 75(3) makes collective responsibility the bedrock of Union parliamentary government in two senses.

Survival: The Council must retain Lok Sabha confidence. A carried no-confidence motion requires resignation or a constitutionally proper dissolution route. Denial of essential supply is similarly grave, though not every legislative defeat automatically equals loss of confidence.

Solidarity: Ministers may disagree internally, but once policy is settled they must defend it publicly; a minister who cannot do so should resign. This gives Parliament one accountable government rather than competing departmental executives.

In *U.N.R. Rao* (1971), the Supreme Court held that dissolution does not terminate the Council: Article 74 ensures continuity while Article 75(3) operates when a House exists to test confidence. *Shamsher Singh* (1974) located responsibility in the advice-giving ministry rather than the formal head. At State level, *S.R. Bommai* (1994) reinforced the House floor as the proper place to test disputed majority.

Thus, collective responsibility unifies authority, accountability and continuity, but must not be confused with suppression of internal debate or a claim that every lost vote dismisses government.

Why this earns marks

- Separates the two limbs named in the question.
- Uses three cases for different propositions rather than decorative citation.
- Adds the supply/ordinary-defeat and State-level qualifications.

M3. 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Compare parliamentary and presidential systems and assess why the parliamentary form remains better suited to India's constitutional conditions.

Demand decoding

- Comparison must use exact axes.
- Assessment needs Indian reasons, counterarguments and a graded verdict.

Model solution

Parliamentary and presidential systems differ primarily in the relationship between executive and legislature.

Axis	Parliamentary	Presidential
Executive	Formal head plus real ministry	Single political executive
Selection	Ministry from legislative support	President separately elected
Tenure	Confidence-dependent	Fixed
Responsibility	Daily to lower House	Not politically responsible to legislature
Membership	Ministers sit in legislature	Executive officers cannot sit in legislature
Structure	Fusion and coordination	Separation and checks

India preferred the parliamentary form for four connected reasons. First, Ambedkar prioritised greater responsibility over the presidential model's greater fixed-term stability. Questions, motions and no-confidence make accountability continuous rather than merely periodic. Second, constitutional experience under late-colonial reforms made responsible institutions administratively familiar. Third, fusion reduced the risk of a separately elected executive and legislature producing deadlock in a new democracy. Fourth, a multi-member cabinet offered room for regional, social and coalition representation in a plural federation. The Swaran Singh Committee later favoured retention.

The choice has costs. Short-lived governments demonstrate instability; majority, whip and PMO control can produce cabinet dominance; generalist ministers invite the "amateur" critique. A presidential system offers tenure stability and access to external expertise.

However, Indian evidence qualifies these objections. Full-term coalitions show that fragmentation need not cause collapse. Expert administration can be supplied without making the executive confidence-independent, while constitutional supremacy, federalism and courts check concentration.

Therefore, parliamentary government remains better suited not because it guarantees good governance, but because its confidence principle, replaceability and coalition capacity align with India's need for continuous accountability and plural accommodation. Reform should strengthen Parliament rather than replace responsible government.

Why this earns marks

- Gives an exact comparison before evaluation.
- Uses Ambedkar, institutional familiarity, pluralism, Swaran Singh and coalition counterevidence.
- Acknowledges presidential advantages and parliamentary failures before defending a qualified Indian choice.

M4. 15 marks | 250 words

Question: "Cabinet dominance in India is a product of constitutional fusion amplified by party and procedural power." Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Separate the constitutional base from political amplifiers.
- Explain consequences and correctives; avoid calling the cabinet legally sovereign.

Model solution

India's parliamentary Constitution deliberately fuses executive and legislative personnel: Articles 74-75 create a ministry drawn from Parliament and sustained by Lok Sabha confidence. Fusion enables coordination and

accountability, but does not alone explain cabinet dominance.

Party amplification: A governing majority normally controls House outcomes. The whip, backed in relevant cases by Tenth Schedule disqualification risk, prioritises party survival over independent legislative judgment. The cabinet therefore commands the very majority meant to scrutinise it.

Procedural amplification: Government business occupies most agenda time. Guillotining of undiscussed demands for grants compresses financial scrutiny. Delegated legislation transfers operational detail to the executive; ordinances under Article 123 can precede debate; an overbroad Money Bill route can reduce Rajya Sabha's role. PM control over appointments, communication and coordination, strengthened by PMO resources, may further convert cabinet government into prime-ministerial government.

Evidence of weakened deliberation: PRS records only 274 sitting days for the full-term 17th Lok Sabha and a committee-referral rate lower than in the 16th and 15th Lok Sabhas. This indicates reduced opportunity for detailed scrutiny, though it does not establish that every enactment was unexamined.

Correctives: Article 75(3) still enables removal through no-confidence. Question Hour, motions, DRSCs, PAC-CAG scrutiny, opposition, bicameralism, courts and elections constrain the executive. Judicial review is especially important because India follows constitutional, not parliamentary, sovereignty.

Thus, cabinet dominance is best seen as **fusion plus disciplined majority plus control of procedure and information**. It marginalises deliberation in practice, not Parliament's constitutional capacity. More sittings, routine committee referral and narrower whip use are the appropriate correctives.

Why this earns marks

- Directly tests and proves both parts of the quotation.
- Adds precise instruments, PRS evidence and constitutional correctives.
- Avoids the major conceptual error of equating executive dominance with legal sovereignty.

M5. 20 marks | 250-300 words

Question: Critically evaluate whether India's parliamentary system has delivered responsibility at an unacceptable cost to stability and policy continuity.

Demand decoding

- "Critically evaluate" requires criteria, positive evidence, negative evidence, counterevidence and a reasoned threshold judgment.
- Responsibility, stability and continuity must all be addressed.

Model solution

India adopted parliamentary government because a democratic executive must be stable yet accountable, and the framers preferred greater day-to-day responsibility. The central question is whether the resulting instability has become disproportionate.

Responsibility delivered: Article 75(3) makes government survival dependent on Lok Sabha confidence. Questions, debates, committees, financial voting and no-confidence expose ministers to continuous scrutiny. A failed ministry can be replaced without constitutional rupture. *Shamsher Singh* places political responsibility on the advice-giving Council, while *U.N.R. Rao* preserves responsible continuity even during dissolution.

Stability and continuity costs: India has seen short-lived governments, particularly in 1979, 1989-91 and 1996-98. Coalition bargaining and defection can delay decisions; a new ministry may reverse policy. Confidence incentives may encourage short-term electoral calculation. The simultaneous-elections proposal itself draws political force from the claim that repeated elections and uncertain terms disrupt governance.

Why the cost is not inherently unacceptable: Full-term coalition governments after 1999 show that negotiated programmes, anti-defection discipline and institutional learning can produce stability. Major economic, welfare, foreign-policy and federal commitments have often continued across governments, demonstrating bureaucratic, judicial and intergovernmental continuity. Presidential fixed tenure would reduce one kind of instability but could create executive-legislative deadlock and concentrate personal mandate.

A deeper responsibility deficit: The more serious modern problem may be too little, not too much, legislative control. Majority whips, reduced sittings, weak committee referral and PMO centralisation can make governments stable while Parliament becomes less deliberative. PRS's 274-day figure for the 17th Lok Sabha illustrates this concern.

Judgment: Parliamentary instability is a designed accountability cost, but it becomes unacceptable only when party fragmentation defeats governance without enabling scrutiny. India's experience is mixed, not a system failure. The priority should be constructive confidence conventions, coalition transparency, stronger committees, predictable sittings and protection of federal/electoral accountability.

Why this earns marks

- Establishes explicit evaluation criteria and follows them.
- Uses Articles, cases, historical instability, coalition counterevidence and PRS evidence.
- Reframes the debate by showing that excessive executive stability can coexist with weak legislative responsibility.

M6. 20 marks | 250-300 words

Question: The simultaneous-elections proposal revives the parliamentary dilemma between stability and accountability. Examine the constitutional trade-offs without treating the proposal as current law.

Demand decoding

- Begin with the verified pending status.
- Use the proposal only as a system-design debate.
- Balance governance claims against confidence flexibility, federalism and voter accountability.

Model solution

The Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024, introduced on 17 December 2024, proposes an Article 82A framework for simultaneous Lok Sabha and Assembly elections. As of 16 August 2026 it remains under Joint Committee review: Article 82A is not current law and no implementation year is established.

Stability case: Fewer election cycles may create a more predictable administrative calendar, reduce repeated mobilisation and give governments a clearer policy horizon. Synchronisation could also reduce the political incentive for continuous campaign mode. These claims echo the presidential advantage of tenure stability without formally replacing parliamentary government.

Accountability cost: Parliamentary government permits a ministry to fall when it loses House confidence. The proposal's remainder-term design after premature dissolution may produce legislatures with very short mandates merely to restore the common cycle. This could weaken the value of a fresh electoral mandate and encourage actors to prioritise calendar preservation over responsive government.

Federal concern: State elections express State-specific accountability. Synchronisation may nationalise campaign issues and alter the balance between Union and State political cycles. A mechanism for deferring a particular Assembly election must also be tested against representative continuity and constitutional safeguards.

Constitutional design issue: Ambedkar's formulation remains apt: no system maximises stability and responsibility equally. Election expenditure and administrative convenience are relevant, but they cannot by themselves displace confidence, federalism and periodic voter sanction. Conversely, staggered elections are not automatically superior if they cause chronic governance avoidance.

Judgment: The proposal should be assessed through necessity, proportionality, federal consultation, workable treatment of early dissolution and protection of House confidence. Stability is valuable only when it serves, rather than freezes, democratic responsibility. Until enactment, it must remain an analytical current-affairs illustration, not a statement of constitutional law.

Why this earns marks

- Opens with exact current control and repeats the non-law qualification.
- Organises analysis into stability, accountability, federalism and design.
- Uses Ambedkar's frame and provides a constitutional test rather than a partisan verdict.